

WAITING FOR HER, WAITING FOR HIM

The first time Rose stood at the edge of a bridge, it was a bright, summer morning. She balanced on the railing, teetering back and forth, forward and back. A stiff breeze in the wrong direction would be all she needed to jump off.

Just kidding; Rose was pretty sure this bridge wasn't high enough to kill anyone. She jumped back onto the walkway, holding onto the rail as she meandered to work. Cars drove by every so often, their whine droning in and out. She stopped at a vending machine at the end of the bridge, her eyes both on it and on the giant forearm in the distance. It seemed as if a giant robot had cut off its arm and stuck it onto the ground. She was too young to remember when it appeared, but her parents often told her of the panic and fear that gripped the hearts of the townspeople when it appeared one night.

"You'd coo at it and kept asking for one in our backyard," Her father used to say. He always talked about how amazing it was, how surreal it seemed. But for Rose, it's always been like that. Nothing amazing happens here. It's just ordinary.

She squinted at the sun rising behind it, beams catching on rusted iron and frayed wires. She decided to get a can of unsweetened coffee. Sea salt air mixed with the bitter aftertaste as she walked along the seaside roads, a beach just to her right. This early in the morning, a handful of fishermen were trying their luck. Most of their baskets were close to empty. One of them caught enough left boots for an entire family. They were there every day, without fail. Unless there was a market for waterlogged left boots, Rose couldn't imagine them making any sort of

living. Or perhaps they did it because it was something they always did, a reminder when the world was full and boots didn't jump out of the baskets on their own.

The winding path took her through a small suburban village at the base of the arm. The burly florist was setting metallic flowers out for display. They smelled of iron and oil, but also sweet and sour. Rose waved at him, the florist nodding back. The grocery store was open early today, a bright-eyed girl helping her grandma bring fruits and vegetables out. In the shadow of the arm, they were content.

But for every shop that was open, there were two more that were closed and decrepit. On a particular Atelier, a sign on the door read, *Gone for holiday. Will be back when the snow melts.* That sign has been there for two years now.

Her phone buzzed. "Rose. I need. I'm a-" through groggy, slurred words, Watts sounded as if he hadn't slept for days- "Coffee. Sed- Sedatives. Caffeine."

"Go to bed Watts." Rose reached the base of the arm, a couple of paths carved through the metal. "Your deadline isn't until next Friday."

Watts made various groans. If Rose listened carefully, she could hear the gears turn in his head. "Coffee," he whispered.

"Coffee," Rose couldn't help a bemused smile. "Good night. Love you, bye."

"Love you, bye," Watts murmured. There was a loud *clack* on his end, followed by heavy snoring.

"Quit dropping your phone, you maniac," Rose rolled her eyes and hung up. Her eyes flickered onto the lock screen, but just as quickly, she put her phone away. Watts wasn't the only person she knew who often had sleepless nights.

Rose walked through the veins within with care. In a memory, two little girls ran through these halls, one with twin tails pulling the other along. *Look, Rose.* The leader of the two pulled a stray panel from the wall. *I'm armed and ready!*

Put that down you crazy kids!

Uh-oh, they found us- run! Rose made extra sure to keep their getaway clear, even if it was these halls were now empty.

She unlocked the office door and peered inside. There wasn't anyone in today; it seemed like no one ever was. Rose couldn't remember the last time she saw her supervisor. But the job requests still came, the money still appeared in her account, and she didn't question it. So, she stayed. It was comfy here. Her littered desk welcomed her with various trinkets and knick-knacks. A little origami crane, a clockwork automaton the size of her fist. There was also a face down picture frame. It was the same as the picture on her phone. On another day the picture gave her strength. Somewhere along the way, that strength was replaced with a vague anxiety.

Rose sighed. She checked her emails. "Ok, let's see how many ducks I can fit in a-" she squinted at the message- "Phoenix Hunting Recruitment Form." Rose looked for ducks online and went through the arcane task of adding fires to their feathers.

Another memory wormed its way into her head. The same two girls from before, now working at a bar. *Hey Rose, check this out!* The girl with twin tails poured a drink and traced her finger around the rim of the cup. Before their eyes, the cup chilled until the liquid froze over. *Bam. On the rocks. I think? I'm pretty sure. I'll just pour some more alcohols in here really quick.*

She smiled a bitter, tired smile and slapped her cheeks. "I need more ducks."

After a long day of modifying ducks, Rose spent an evening walking on the beach. The fishers were long gone by then, replaced by the gentle lapping of low tide. Every once in a while, she'd look back and watch the waves wipe away her footsteps. The bridge was silhouetted upon the setting sun and Rose thought she saw someone waiting for her further along the beach. But there weren't any tracks for her to follow. Rose sat down and watched the sun. She watched the red and orange hues turn to dark blues and purples. She watched the twinkling dots of the stars start to appear, one by one, by the tens and the hundreds.

I've been given these abilities for a reason. Rose remembered the words spoken to her on this beach. *The stars are going out, I can spit fire and shout ice, and there's a robot arm in our town. There's more out there than that thing. And I want to find it.*

Rose took out her phone and let the lock screen illuminate her way. On it, was a picture taken about four years ago. Rose was 19 at the time, one of two girls in bartending uniforms. They looked like quite the pair, one with red eyes and her hair in a bun. A heart was drawn over her mouth, two blush stickers stuck on. The other girl had twin tails and dark brown eyes. She had an arm around the other girl, sporting a grin wide enough to split the moon. *Rose and Me <3*, it read.

Rose raised her arm and aimed for the water. She stayed there, ready to throw her phone into the drink. Instead, she tossed it behind into the sand behind her. She laid down and raised her arms to the sky, waving them around like a conductor to an invisible symphony only she could hear. There wasn't any reason why- it was just something that felt right.

I want to find out why these things are happening. You'll be the first person I'll tell. Wait for me, Rose.

"Three years, Eva," Rose picked up her phone started the long walk home. "Three god damned years."

#

The second time Rose stood at the edge of a bridge, she was on her way home on a brisk, white Christmas night. The bus sign reflected the soft, orange streetlights, a tray of coffee resting on the edge beside her. Before this year, she'd never seen snow come this close to the sea. Rose wondered if it would hurt if she fell off. How far was it? Ten meters? Twenty? At a certain distance, hitting still water is like hitting concrete. But surely, the bridge wasn't that far up from the water. The jobs stopped coming in- she hadn't seen an email in weeks. The money still dropped into her account every two weeks, but...

Rose pulled out her key to the office. *Come on Rose. Even if you don't have any magic, we'd only be wasting away here. Come with me. We'll find it together.* In a flash of insanity or emotion, she tossed the key off the edge. When it disappeared into the sea, she teetered forward as if to get it back.

A chilling wind prompted Rose to jump back onto the safe side. She picked up the coffees and hurried on home. It's fine, this is fine. Watts can cover the expenses for a while.

Their small, dilapidated house was built into the side of a train station. It was two-bedrooms with a kitchen, a living room, and a very lovely bathroom. Despite the entire house shaking whenever a train would pull in or out of the station, or perhaps because of it, it was a comfy little nook. On a rainy night, Rose liked to sit on the coach with a warm beverage in hand. Perhaps *The Hogfather* would be playing, perhaps Watts would be playing *Final Fantasy*. Perhaps tonight was one of those nights.

Rose stepped in to find the lights switched off, white noise playing from the speakers. She knocked on Watts' door.

"Cofvefe," She said. There was a panicked rustling within his room and then it opened.

"Cofvefe?" He squinted through a full curtain of hair, taking his glasses off and tying his hair back. Once he saw the tray of coffee, his bloodshot eyes instantly lit up. "Cofvefe."

He took the try from Rose's hands, gave her a cup, then disappeared back into his den.

Rose sighed. "Watts, get out here. I'm not about to let you spend your entire Christmas animating horse cocks."

"It pays well, and you know it!" Rose rolled her eyes to his muffled shouting. "Let me just finish adding in voice. I'll have it rendering soon."

"Fine, just hurry up." She went into her mess of a room, clothes strewn about the floor. Laundry day would have to be tomorrow or the next day. Freeing herself from her office attire, Rose slipped into comfy pajamas and leaned against the window. Lit by faint streetlights, the outside of the train station was slow and still. Commuters walked to and fro, like wandering specters disappearing into the night. Snowdrifts were starting to form.

Watts hobbled of his den and into the bathroom. There was a muffled scream, a frustrated roar that wasn't infrequent. After a few more moments, Watts got out of the bathroom with heavy steps and slumped onto the couch.

"Everything alright in there?" Rose lounged next to him, taking sips of her coffee every so often.

"I'd wait an hour," Watts said. He scratched the back of his neck and Rose let it slide. "Did you know Angela was sick?"

"I did not." Rose picked out something from the backlog and started the TV. "What happened?"

"She got laryngitis awhile back. She wasn't able to finish her lines so I had to get someone else to do it. You know what's her face?" Watts snapped his fingers and wracked his head. "The girl who looks kind of like you? Green eyes? Elmo?"

"Murphy?"

"Murphy!" Watts grinned as the name stuck. "Yeah, I had to call her a week ago. I didn't think she'd accept, but she was nice enough to help out."

"I wonder why you'd think she wouldn't accept," Rose said, her voice as flat as a wall.

"Listen, lots of voice actors get started in animated porn. There's absolutely nothing wrong with it," Watts said. "Besides, Angela already prerecorded some of the harder lines. I just had Murphy clean some things up. She wanted to expand her range anyway, so it's a win-win."

"I guess," Rose watched the scenes on the TV in silence for a little bit. "I quit my job today."

Watts didn't miss a beat. "Good for you," he said. "If you aren't happy at a place, you should move somewhere else. Simple as that." His shoulders dropped a bit and it didn't take Rose long to figure out why. "No point wasting away in comfort."

"Like a certain someone you know?" Rose cleared her throat and chose her words carefully. "Have you spoken with Niel at all?"

"I have not." Watts kept his eyes on the screen. "And I don't think I will."

"Why?"

He leaned back. They'd had this conversation before. Rose expected him to shrug and not offer another word. But tonight was a white Christmas night. "That's an unfair word," he looked

at Rose, but his eyes weren't on her. They were far, far away, to a time before Watts knew Rose.

"I mean, how could I? I left him first. By now, he's probably moved on. At the very least, if he was smart, he should have."

"I haven't," Rose said.

"And I think that's very stupid," Watts laughed, a bitter and forced sound. "Come on Roseline, you've been waiting for this chick for five years without so much of a word. If I were in your shoes, I'd be really upset. If you're not, you should be."

Rose set her cup down and rested her head on the armrest. "I mean, I'm not *not* upset. But if I were Neil, I'd still like to hear from you, y'know? At the very least, I'd like to know if you were even alive."

Watts alternated between opening his mouth to just pointing at her. "You're right. I don't like it, but you're right," He said through grit teeth.

The unmistakable sound of a train horn echoed throughout the night, the steady *chugga-chugga* shaking the walls of their home. Glints of light caught Rose's eye. As she peeked outside the window, she saw two comets hurtling through the night sky. One was blue and the other was red, orbiting around each other and leaving a double helix in their wake. She spun her fingers around, pretending to conduct their spins. Rose hummed a soft, nostalgic tune, a little ditty that went around and around.

Rose looked at her phone, then turned back to him. "I think you should call him."

Watts rested his knuckles on his knees. "I've moved on." Each word was halted and forced, as if finding them for the first time. "I think, I think I really moved on. I can't imagine a life with Niels. I can imagine a life with you, I can imagine a life on my own. If I think really hard, I could even imagine a life with someone else. But Niels? The person who left him to

follow his dreams is very different than the person who currently draws animated titties. Hell, I've got a different dream than what I started with." The corners of his mouth lifted. It wasn't a smile, not in any sense of the word. But it was accepting and a little rueful. "Niels was always quick to settle- never wanted anything more than what he got."

"Like his magic?"

"Oh my god." Watts pinched the bridge of his nose. "Don't get me started. He had the chance to learn how to fly and he decides to stick to the ground. 'It's fine like this? Isn't it?' he says. Bullshit, it was not fine. So much potential from him and he couldn't see past our small-town fence in the middle of nowhere."

"Listen Watts," Rose moved closer to Niels and grabbed both of his hands. "As the person on the other side of the fence, you have an opportunity for both of you to get closure, at the very worst. If Eva ever told me she was never coming back, at least it would be better than nothing."

Watts bowed his head and chuckled. "I think that's the biggest difference between you and Niels. Niels would've let this fester. He would've sat down, said everything was fine, then hoped things would resolve itself. Well then? What about you, brave sage on the other side of the fence? It's a two-way fence."

"I can't," It was Rose's turn to be subdued. She handed her phone to Watts and showed him the lock screen. "Funny story about this picture. Eva took this picture on her phone and she never sent it to me. When she said she'd give me something to remember her by, I really wish it wasn't the only thing I could have contacted her on. "

"Oh," Watts nodded. Then his brow furrowed. "Oh Rose."

"I don't know." Rose leaned into him and shook her head. "I really don't."

#

A month after Christmas, the money did stop coming in. But Rose didn't really care about that for two reasons. The first is that their cost of living was remarkably low. Having trains shake the property every so often brought the market value down. The second was that Watts made a lot of money from the perverts. She had freedom to lounge around and do nothing. It was quite liberating at first. In one instance, she even helped the fishermen with their morning boot catches. Having her around to explain their old techniques brought a spark of life to them, little stories of the mythical Big One. Rose was glad to let them relive their glory days, if only for a little bit. They fished because it was what they do. If God Itself came down and told them to stop fishing, they would flip him off and walk backwards into hell. Rose didn't have that. She didn't have that hill to die on.

She lazed around for two months at home, either reading about mysterious signs of dragon claws, heavy sonar *blips* appearing in the deepest of oceans, unexplained meteors that would orbit around the planet. Her generation was supposed to be teeming with awakened magical gifts. Eva was one of those gifted, straight as an arrow and sharp as one to boot.

"She'd never lie around like this," Rose said. She sat on the couch upside-down, watching the news. Perhaps magic exists and it can be taught, magic is fake and is reliant on drugs, the days of Revelation has started. Not a day goes by without the news covering someone claiming to be the Anti-Christ. Eventually, Rose got fed up with lying around and knocked on Watts' for help. The door creaked open and Watts hadn't moved from his computer.

"Need something?" He asked.

"You and Eva both seem to know exactly what you want, or at the very least, how to get there," Rose threw her hands in the air. "Help."

"I'm sure it looks like that," Watts said, a hint of amusement in his voice. "But from my end, I haven't got the slightest clue. Just try stuff. Try voice acting."

"But I've gotta make sounds," Rose felt a hint of pink in her cheeks. "I can't possibly do that."

"People like it. There's a market, people are grateful, and finished products are always nice. Really, that's all there is to it." Watts motioned for her to come in. "Here, I'll show you what my voice actresses do. Maybe you'll find something there."

Rose took his advice and looked around the room. It was close to spotless, with a piano and a guitar tucked away in the corner. There were framed and signed pictures of all the animations he worked on. Most of them featured women in various states of undress, some as pin-ups, other surrounded by various species of genitalia. The only one that wasn't perverted was signed with a single name. *As long as you long for something more <3 - Niels*

"What are these for?" Rose asked.

Watts tilted his head and glanced at the wall before turning back to his animation. "Those are my finished projects. I'd commission a poster and ask the voice actors and actresses to sign them for me."

"And Niel?"

"Niels gave me emotional support for my first breakout animation." Watts smiled. "Of course I'd get him to sign it. You know, I called him too. He's married now, which is good for him. He also tops, which I couldn't believe."

"That's good for you," Rose said.

"Yeah. What you said about closure was dead on," Watts smiled. "Anyway, have a look." Watts waited until Rose was watching the screen, then he pressed play.

If there wasn't a part of her body that was blushing, there certainly was now. "Anatomy doesn't work that way."

"Ignore that part," Watts rolled his eyes. "But what do you think?"

Rose let the burning in her ears subside before making an answer. "I don't think it's for me."

"That's fine." Watts exited the video and ushered Rose out. "Now we know that's not your calling. I'll try a little harder in helping you after I finish getting everything pulled together for this one. Sounds fair?"

He shrugged and found an energy shot in the kitchen. He downed it in one and gave Rose a thumbs up before disappearing back into his room.

With still a lot on her mind, Rose took a walk back to the bridge. She leaned against the railing, feeling the salty sea breeze grasp at her hair, and the setting sun fondle her back. The gentle lull of the low tide was hypnotic, and Rose thought about what Eva would do in this situation.

"She'd jump, with reckless abandon," Rose said, tracing the rolling of the waves with her index finger. She hummed something to herself, a little secret meant only for her.

The droning of passing cars was an afterthought, until the exhausted relief of a stopping bus caught her attention.

She turned and a single passenger stepped out. He was a gentleman pushing his fifties, yet he had a silver mane and beard that was almost like starlight. Despite his sharp, gray, three-piece suit, he had a dirty rucksack over one shoulder and a violin case in the other.

"Do I know you?" he asked. "I was on holiday and I live around that, you see." He pointed at the giant arm. "I feel like I've seen you around at some point."

"Oh, I commuted there, yeah," Rose said.

"Working at the arm, I presume?" The gentleman set his rucksack aside and leaned on the railing with Rose. "You shouldn't do that. You don't know when that robot will need its arm back."

"Well, I don't work there anymore. In fact, I don't really work anywhere, really," Rose shrugged.

"I see," the gentleman stroked his beard. "Well, I'm sure you'll manage. You're young, you've got plenty of life in you."

"I don't know. I had someone who I cared about a lot. She always seemed to know what she wanted. And if she didn't, she knew how to get there. I don't know how. And I know I've got time, but-" Rose shrugged "-I don't know. It still feels bad."

"In this situation, what would your friend do?" The gentleman asked. He had this sly, knowing grin on his face, as if he had done this many times before.

"She'd jump off this bridge and go from there," Rose said.

The gentleman cleared his throat and looked over the edge. "Well, this fall certainly isn't enough to kill you. It might kill me at my age. But it's better to make a decision than to not make one, ey? Easier to clear mistakes than regrets."

"In that case," Rose climbed onto the edge of the bridge.

"Wait, hold on! I didn't mean right now!" The gentleman grabbed Rose's arm. "Are you daft?"

Rose tried to shake him loose. "But I won't know until I try! You just said to make a decision!"

"Young lady, as the responsible adult in this situation, at least think about why you're jumping," The gentleman pulled Rose back onto the bridge. "How about I play you a melody? Songs can transcend many things. Emotions into sound, thoughts into words. At the very least, think about why you feel the way you do."

"Fine," Rose leaned back on the railings and waited for the gentleman to unpack his violin. He slid rosin over the bow and placed the violin in the crook of his neck, making slight adjustments to the tunings in a comfortable way that bespoke years of experience.

And he began to play. From the first note, Rose was enraptured. He started low and played sweet tones that reminded her of sunlit rooms, of warm days unburdened by memories from tomorrows. He played higher and higher, the melody flowing from one spot to the next. But despite the sweetness of his sound, there was an undertone of something more. Of tomorrows that became today's, of words that were left unsaid. He played of a fragile happiness, of wasted days and goodbyes that never came. The gentleman moved with his music, dancing to an invisible beat which set Rose's heart ablaze. For the briefest of moments, he reminded her of Eva.

When he finished, both he and Rose were misty-eyed.

"And there you have it, a melody from my misspent youth." The gentleman bowed.

"Have you gleaned anything from that?"

"A little bit," Rose wiped the tears away.

"And?"

"I don't know why Eva did the things she did. I can't even explain why she'd jump here." With renewed resolve, she got back onto the edge of the bridge. "But I know I need to. If I don't now, when will I ever?"

"If that is your decision, I'll respect it," The gentleman placed his instrument away with the greatest of care, watching for what Rose would do next. The breeze picked up, cradling Rose in its arms.

The last time Rose stood at the edge of the bridge, she could feel her heart pound in her ears. Her stomach churned and the water felt farther than usual. This feeling in her chest swelled and swelled until it was set to burst. She thought of the gentleman's melody, of that nostalgic happiness. She thought of Watts and his pride in his work. She thought of Eva, of her stupid grin and her longing for something more.

Wait for me, Rose. Eva had told her once.

I love you. Goodbye. With that last thought, Rose jumped. She felt as if she was in the air for minutes, for hours. She felt her stomach being left behind at the top of the bridge and that the water was coming faster than she thought. And in that moment, she remembered. Her phone was still in her pocket.

She stabbed through the surface of the water like a knife, the frigid sea shocking her senses. Rose's instincts kicked in and she broke the surface, taking in gasps of air as she began to tread water. Despite freezing, despite having the air knocked out of her from the impact, Rose laughed. She waved back at the top of the bridge, at the gentleman who was one second away from jumping in after her. He visibly sighed when he saw her, then shot two thumbs up. Rose swam back to shore, feeling lighter than ever.

#

The gentleman gave Rose his gray jacket and wished her all the best, but not before a quick scolding on the importance of proper diving form. And then she walked home, still soaking wet. That night was the first time Watts yelled at Rose. She smiled at his fretting, at his

panicked scolding. He flew about the kitchen, making a nice, warm soup which reminded her of home.

"Are you out of your god damned mind?" Watts said to Rose. Rose remembered how Eva would don a coy smile, tilting her head with a hand on her chin as if she had all the answers.

"It seemed like a good idea at the time," Rose echoed Eva's words. She tilted her head, holding the same pose Eva did all those years ago. "Y'know what? In hindsight, it really was."

Watts made an "are you messing with me?" face and froze. Rose couldn't help herself and threw her head back in laughter. It was a deep, infectious laugh, one that came from her stomach and left her gasping for air. Watts was probably fuming at this point, completely enraged at her disregard for his concern. Rose knew she was fuming when Eva laughed at her concern.

Rose laughed for a minute, maybe two. As Rose wiped the tears from her eyes, she expected Watts to be yelling something about her safety, his worries, and all sorts of things.

Instead, he was sitting down, pinching the bridge of his nose as he muttered something.

"Hey, Watts, I'm sorry, I really am. I just thought it was ironic," Rose said.

"You're not the only one," Watts waved her off. He sighed and shouted to the ceiling, "So this was what it was like to deal with me, isn't that right, Niels?"

Rose beamed at him.

"Stop grinning at me and get dry." Watts hugged her. "I'm just glad you're ok."

Rose nodded and went into her room to change. She pulled her waterlogged phone out, the screen a static mess. She placed it next to a picture frame on her bedside table, the same one from her work desk. When she hung the gentleman's jacket to dry, she thought of the melody he played. Over and over, it repeated in her head. Over and over, the emotions welled in her chest. She wanted to yell, to scream, to cry. She wanted to hear that melody again. She hummed it to

herself, as soft as she could. The sound fluttered around the room, a breeze blanketing her in warmth.

"Hey Watts." She poked her head out, Watts still tending to the soup. "How well can you teach someone music theory?"

#

A couple of months later, winter returned. Rose didn't know when and if it would leave. Apparently, the tropics themselves were starting to freeze over, with the poles starting to melt. Thus, Rose and Watts packed their things, waiting at the station for their respective trains to arrive.

"Promise to find a place for the both of us?" Rose asked him.

"Only if you promise to call," Watts squeezed her hand. "Where's your first stop?"

"It's a bit far." Rose adjusted the gray jacket. She once tried giving it back to the gentleman, but he was having none of it. "Jude says the Singing Towers would be a good start."

"Bring earplugs, I've heard they get loud on windy days." Watts spotted a train coming into the station. He picked up a guitar case and handed it to Rose. "Don't forget your bass."

"Wouldn't dream of it." She shouldered it and gave him a tight hug. "Don't overwork yourself."

"Can't promise that." He hugged back. "Angela graduated to the big leagues. I'm gonna need to find someone else to fill her roles."

Rose smiled and pulled away. "Maybe you should graduate to the big leagues yourself."

Watts shrugged. "Nope. It's too fun to do what I do."

The conductor called all aboard, and Rose headed to her train, looking back every so often to wave at Watts. Rose boarded, thinking about how Eva must have felt when she boarded

her own train. Did she want to go back? Did she want to return to comfy evenings of doing nothing? There was a part of her that did. As a girl with twin tails and dark brown eyes walked down the aisle, there was a part of her that wanted to see who she was. But there was a bigger part that wanted more. She didn't know what she wanted more of. But as she sat on her seat, she looked outside her window. Even as the train began to pull out, Watts was there, watching the train leave. Waiting for what Rose would bring back.

She brought out her phone. It was a new thing, one that still had its screen protector. The photo on it was of her and Watts, tangled in the snow together. *Waiting for you, Waiting for you*, in both her handwriting and his. She called him.

"Hey," She said. "Yeah, no, I figured you would've missed me if I didn't call. Looks like I got it first then."

The two had an idle chat, one of important and unimportant things. Watts just talked about the blistering cold. Rose talked about all the rocks in the sky, of the various hues of sunset she could see in the distance. She could see the robot arm shrink as the train chugged further along. And when she heard the unmistakable sound of train horns, she made sure to tell Watts to call her tomorrow if she didn't.

"I know you'll forget, set an alarm," she demanded. "I mean it. Ok, fine. Yeah. Love you, bye."

Rose hung up, still humming that nostalgic melody. The wind followed her notes, bouncing up and down as it breezed into the unknown.